

L'cha Dodi

(for S'fira / Ben HaMetzarim)

10u

Version 3

Julius Mombach
Arr. Stuart Izon

As mentioned above, there is a historic practice of changing the tune for L'cha Dodi on the Shabbatot during the Omer period. In the mid 19th century, Mombach wrote this magnum opus, which is distinct from the traditional S'fira melody, to be used for both the Omer period and also for the Shabbatot during the Three Weeks. This venerated tradition is still upheld in many UK congregations, with some reportedly adapting the melody for other prayers e.g. Ein Keloheinu.

This is a complex work for chazzan and choir, with contrasting sections emphasising the meaning of the words. Structurally, Mombach follows the old tradition of changing to a faster tune at Hitor'ri (not Lo Tevoshi as per contemporary practice), and returning to the first part of the melody for Boi V'shalom. As I mentioned above, there is some disagreement regarding the use of a melancholic tune for L'cha Dodi, as public mourning is generally forbidden on Shabbat. However, kabbalat shabbat is typically said prior to the onset of Shabbat in both the S'fira period and Ben Hametzarim (in the northern hemisphere, at least). Mombach astutely modulates to the parallel major at the final refrain as we welcome the Shabbat in delight.

Mombach's melody does not utilise the traditional S'fira Lecha Dodi tune anywhere, although the editors of the Blue Book sought to incorporate that into Mombach's piece, replacing his Boi V'shalom Da Capo. In my opinion this is a rather clumsy and unwarranted amalgamation. However, when this piece is sung during the Three Weeks, the verse Boi V'shalom is indeed replaced with the melody for Eli Tzion (according to both Mombach's score and the Blue Book).

Andante

Chazzan

Melody Alto

Tenor Bass

C.

M A

T B

p L' - cha do - di li - krat ka - la p' - nei sha -

pp Ah

-bat n' - ka - b' - la

mp L' - cha do - di li -

12

M
A

8

mf *p*

-krat ka - la p' - nei sha - bat n' - ka - b' - la

T
B

18

M
A

8

mp

Sha - mor v' - za - chor b' - di - bur e - chad hish - mi -
Mik - dash me - lech ir m' - lu - cha ku - mi tz' -

T
B

24

M
A

8

- a - nu el ha - m' - yu - chad a - do - nai e - chad ush -
- i mi - toch ha - ha - fe - cha rav lach she - vet b' -

T
B

29

M
A

8

- mo e - chad l' - shem ul - ti fe - ret v' - lit - hi -
- e - mek ha - ba - cha v' - hu ya - cha - mol a - la - yich chem -

T
B

34

M
A

8

p *f*

-la L'-cha do - di li-krat ka - la p'-nei sha - bat n'-ka - b' - la
 -la L'-cha do - di li-krat ka - la p'-nei sha - bat n'-ka - b' - la

T
B

39

C.

8

p

Li - krat sha - bat l' - chu v'-nel - cha ki hi m' - kor
 Hit - na - a - ri me-a - far ku - mi liv - shi big - dei tif - ar -

M
A

8

pp Ah Ah

T
B

46

C.

8

3

ha - b' - ra - cha me - rosh mi - ke - dem n' - su - cha
 - teich a - mi al yad ben yi-shai beit ha - lach - mi kor-

M
A

8

Ah

T
B

52

C.

8

sof _____ ma-a-se b'-ma-cha-sha-va t'-chi - la _____
 -va _____ el naf-shi _____ g' - a - - la _____

M
A

8

Ah _____ *mp* L' - cha do - di _____ li -

T
B

58

M
A

8

-krat _____ ka - la _____ *mf* p' - nei _____ sha - bat _____ *p* n' - ka - b' - la

T
B

64

Allegro con spirito

M
A

8

f Hit-o - r' - ri hit - o - r' - ri _____ ki va o - rech _____ ku - mi _____
 V' - ha - yu lim-shi-sa _____ sho - sa - yich v' - ra - cha - ku _____ kol m' - va - l' -

T
B

68

M
A

8

o - ri *f* u - ri u - ri shir - da - bei - ri k' - vod a - do - nai a - la - yich nig-
 - a - yich ya - sis a - la - yich e - lo - ha - yich kim - sos cha - tan _____ al ka -

T
B

72

M
A

8

-la L' - cha do - di li - krat ka - la p' -

-la

T
B

L' - cha l' - cha do - di li krat li - krat ka - la p' -

77

M
A

8

-nei sha - bat n' - ka - b' - la

T
B

-nei sha - bat n' - ka - b' - la

81

Adagio

C.

8

p Lo te - vo - shi v' - lo ti - ka - l' - mi ma tish -
Ya - min us - mol tif - ro - tzi v' - et a - do -

M
A

8

pp Ah Ah

T
B

87

C. *8*

-to - cha-chi u - ma te - he - mi *mp* bach ye-che - su a - ni -
 -nai ta - a - ri - - tzi al yad ish

M *8*

A *8* Ah

T *8*

B *8*

92

C. *8*

-yei a - mi v' - niv - n' - ta ir al ti -
 ben par - tzi v' - nis - m' - cha v' - na gi -

M *8*

A *8* Ah

T *8*

B *8*

97

C. *8*

-la
 -la

M *8*

A *mf* L' - cha do - di *p* li - krat ka - la *f* p' -

T *8*

B *8*

102

M
A

8

-nei sha - bat n' - ka - b' - la la

T
B

1. 2.

for S'fira

107 **Andante**

C.

8

mp Bo - i v'-sha - lom a - te - ret ba - la gam b'-sim -

M
A

8

Ah

T
B

112

C.

8

-cha uv - tza - ho - la toch e - mu - nei

M
A

8

Ah

T
B

mf

117

C. *mf* am s'-gu - la *p* bo - i cha - la bo - i cha - la

M A Ah

T B

Piu Mosso

123

M A *mf* L - cha do - di li - krat ka - la p' -

T B

128

M A -nei sha - bat n' - ka - b' - la *f* n'-ka - b' -

T B *f* n'-ka - b' - la

133 **molto rit.**

C. *pp* n' - ka - b' - la

M A -la n'-ka - b' - la *pp* n' - ka - b' - la

T B n'-ka - b' - la n' - ka - b' - la

for Ben HaMetzarim

Andante

Chazzan

mp
Bo - i v'-sha - lom a - te - ret ba - la gam b'-sim -

Melody Alto

p
Ah

Tenor Bass

6

C.

p
-cha uv - tza - ho - la toch e - mu - nei

M A

p
Ah

T B

11

C.

p
am s'-gu - la bo - i cha - la bo - i cha - la

M A

p
Ah

T B

Piu Mosso

17

M
A

8

mf

L' - cha - do - di li - krat - ka - la p' -

T
B

22

M
A

8

-nei sha - bat - n' - ka - b' - la *f* n' - ka - b' -

T
B

f n' - ka - b' - la

27

molto rit.

C.

8

pp n' - ka - b' - la

M
A

8

-la n' - ka - b' - la *pp* n' - ka - b' - la

T
B

n' - ka - b' - la n' - ka - b' - la